

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience managing case files end to end, drafting legal documentation and handling competing procedural deadlines at BCLP, Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Adobe. Experienced in document review, electronic bundling, court filing, and maintaining organised matter records. Familiar with property disputes and real estate litigation through a six-month rotation at BCLP. Methodical and deadline-focused, with strong written communication skills developed across client-facing and document-heavy roles.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a caseload of housing, debt, employment and benefits matters from instruction through to submission, maintaining confidential case records and meeting procedural deadlines throughout
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules; ensures all required documentation is complete and submitted within required timescales
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies evidential gaps across welfare, housing and family matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across several active property matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold disputes and landlord and tenant issues
- Prepared client notes, maintained matter records via iManage, and tracked deadlines and hearing arrangements across competing files
- Assisted with court filings, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons; managed large volumes of confidential documents to strict deadlines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions to meet a significant submission deadline
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translation work
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate agreed amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: End-to-end file management; document drafting and review; hearing bundle preparation; procedural deadline tracking; case-file organisation; court filing and matter administration